

C360

# Teacher Work Sample in English Language Learning

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

**What this is.** Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

**Source.** Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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## How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | _____  |                               |

# Items

1.

A third-grade teacher's class includes 14 students who speak Spanish at home, three of whom are newcomers at entering (level 1) English proficiency. The school opened a new gymnasium this year and ranks in the middle of the district on state tests. Which factor should most directly shape her unit plan?

- A. None; contextual factors are only background for the report
- B. The new gymnasium and its schedule
- C. The school's district test ranking
- D. The students' English proficiency levels, especially the three newcomers

|                             |                                           |                       |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|

2.

A fourth-grade teacher whose class meets right after lunch is writing goals for a science unit. Her mentor teacher prefers color-coded lesson plans. Which goal is written best for a class with many English learners?

- A. Students will complete the water cycle worksheet.
- B. Students will understand the water cycle.
- C. Students will enjoy learning about weather.
- D. Students will describe the stages of the water cycle orally using the sequence words first, next, and then.

|                             |                                           |                       |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A goal reads: "Students will explain two causes of the American Revolution in writing using because and so." Which part is the language objective?

- A. Explaining in writing using because and so
- B. The whole goal is a content objective
- C. None; language objectives belong only in ESL pull-out class
- D. Two causes of the American Revolution

|                             |                                           |                       |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>____ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|

4.

A teacher at a Title I school gave a 10-item pre-assessment on identifying equivalent fractions. For the post-assessment, groups made posters about fractions in cooking, scored for creativity and neatness. Several families volunteered to help with the posters. What is the main problem with this assessment plan?

- A. Posters can never be valid assessments.
- B. The pre-assessment should have counted toward report-card grades.
- C. Ten items is too few for any pre-assessment.
- D. The post-assessment does not measure the same goal as the pre-assessment, so no gain can be claimed.

|                             |                                           |                      |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>___ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|

5.

A level-2 English learner who joined the class in January will take a science unit test on density. The teacher has two years of experience and a teaching assistant in the room. Which support keeps the test measuring the same skill?

- A. Remove the density calculation questions from her test.
- B. Read the directions aloud and allow a bilingual word-to-word glossary without definitions.
- C. Give a glossary that defines density and shows the formula.
- D. Give no supports, because every student must take an identical test.

|                             |                                           |                      |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>___ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which change to a unit test is a modification rather than an accommodation?

- A. Allowing extended time
- B. Replacing grade-level problems with easier problems on a lower standard
- C. Testing in a small, quiet group
- D. Letting the student respond orally

|                             |                                           |                      |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>___ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|

7.

A seventh-grade science teacher in a school with block scheduling lectures at normal speed on photosynthesis to a class with five newcomers. The class has a new set of laptops. Which change best makes the lesson comprehensible to the newcomers?

- A. Wait until they are fluent before teaching them science.
- B. Speak louder and repeat the lecture word for word.
- C. Pre-teach key words and use diagrams, a real plant, gestures, and slower speech with checks for understanding.
- D. Assign a harder text so they are pushed to catch up.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

8.

After a three-week unit taught in October, a teacher reports that English learners averaged 30% on the pre-assessment and 70% on the post. Non-English learners averaged 50% and 80%. The principal observed one lesson. Which statement is supported by the data?

- A. Non-English learners learned more because their post score was higher.
- B. Both groups gained the same because both finished at or above 70%.
- C. English learners gained 40 points, more than the 30-point gain of non-English learners.
- D. English learners gained 70 points.

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student scored 12 out of 20 on the pre-assessment and 18 out of 20 on the post. What is the gain in percentage points?

- A. 30 percentage points
- B. 6 percentage points
- C. 90 percentage points
- D. 50 percentage points

| Target word | The one fact that decides | Answer | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ] guess |
|-------------|---------------------------|--------|-------------------------------|
| _____       | _____                     | ___    |                               |

10.

A fifth grader who arrived from Brazil 14 months ago jokes easily with classmates and plays on the soccer team, but struggles to explain answers in her social studies textbook. Her older brother is in high school. What best explains the gap?

- A. Conversational language develops in 1–3 years, but academic language takes about 5–7.
- B. She likely has a learning disability and should be referred now.
- C. She is fully proficient, so it is a motivation problem.
- D. Academic language develops first, so her textbook skills should be ahead.

|                             |                                           |                      |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>___ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants an activity that builds academic language (CALP) rather than social language. Which fits best?

- A. Memorizing a word list with no content task
- B. Any speaking activity, since all talk builds both equally
- C. Practicing compare-and-contrast signal words while writing a lab report
- D. Practicing greetings for the morning meeting

|                             |                                           |                      |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>___ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|

12.

After a unit on fractions, 3 of 5 level-1 English learners did not meet the goal. The school's science fair was held the same week. Which reflection is strongest for the work sample?

- A. I will reteach the same lessons exactly as before.
- B. My vocabulary pre-teaching was too brief for level-1 students; next time I will add sentence frames and daily exit tickets to check understanding.
- C. Those students did not try hard enough.
- D. The lesson was fine; the test must have been the problem.

|                             |                                           |                      |                                  |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Target word</b><br>_____ | <b>The one fact that decides</b><br>_____ | <b>Answer</b><br>___ | [ ] sure [ ] unsure [ ]<br>guess |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------|

# STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

# Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

## 1. Answer D Concept 1

A third-grade teacher's class includes 14 students who speak Spanish at home, three of whom are newcomers at entering (level 1) English proficiency. ~~The school opened a new gymnasium this year and ranks in the middle of the district on state tests.~~ Which factor should most directly shape her unit plan?

**Target word:** which contextual factor matters most for planning **Decides:** Newcomers at level 1 need planned language scaffolds.

|   |                   |                                                                                    |
|---|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Absolute language | Contextual factors are meant to drive planning decisions.                          |
| B | Camouflage        | A school facility fact that does not shape instruction for these learners.         |
| C | Adjacent category | A school-level statistic; planning should respond to these students' needs.        |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | Proficiency levels decide scaffolds, grouping, and how students can show learning. |

## 2. Answer D Concept 2

A fourth-grade teacher ~~whose class meets right after lunch~~ is writing goals for a science unit. ~~Her mentor teacher prefers color-coded lesson plans.~~ Which goal is written best for a class with many English learners?

**Target word:** best-written goal **Decides:** Observable outcome plus a language objective.

|   |                   |                                                                      |
|---|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Confusion set     | Names an activity, not a learning outcome.                           |
| B | Dropped element   | "Understand" is not observable, and there is no language objective.  |
| C | Adjacent category | An affective hope, not a measurable learning goal.                   |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | Observable content outcome paired with a language function and form. |

## 3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A goal reads: "Students will explain two causes of the American Revolution in writing using because and so." Which part is the language objective?

**Target word:** reverse: pick the language part out of a goal **Decides:** Language objectives name the language function or form.

|   |                   |                                                                       |
|---|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | That names the language form students must produce.                   |
| B | Adjacent category | It combines content with a language form.                             |
| C | Absolute language | Content teachers of ELLs pair language objectives with content goals. |
| D | Confusion set     | That is the content objective.                                        |

## 4. Answer D Concept 3

A teacher ~~at a Title I school~~ gave a 10-item pre-assessment on identifying equivalent fractions. For the post-assessment, groups made posters about fractions in cooking, scored for creativity and neatness. ~~Several families volunteered to help with the posters.~~ What is the main problem with this assessment plan?

**Target word:** flaw in the assessment plan **Decides:** The post does not measure the same goal as the pre.

|   |                   |                                                                            |
|---|-------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Absolute language | Performance tasks can be valid if they are aligned and scored to the goal. |
| B | Adjacent category | Grading policy is a separate issue from alignment.                         |
| C | Wrong stem number | Length is not the flaw; misalignment is.                                   |
| D | <b>Correct</b>    | Pre and post must be aligned to the same goal and scoring.                 |

## 5. Answer B Concept 4

A level-2 English learner ~~who joined the class in January~~ will take a science unit test on density. ~~The teacher has two years of experience and a teaching assistant in the room.~~ Which support keeps the test measuring the same skill?

**Target word:** accommodation that preserves the construct **Decides:** The test measures density, not English reading.

|          |                   |                                                                               |
|----------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Adjacent category | That is a modification; it changes what is measured.                          |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | Improves access to language while still measuring density.                    |
| C        | Confusion set     | Supplies the tested content itself, so the test no longer measures it.        |
| D        | Absolute language | Accommodations are allowed so language does not block the measure of content. |

## 6. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

Which change to a unit test is a modification rather than an accommodation?

**Target word:** reverse: identify the modification **Decides:** Only one option changes what is measured.

|          |                    |                                                     |
|----------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set      | Changes timing only; the content is the same.       |
| <b>B</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Changes the content and standard measured.          |
| C        | Dropped element    | Changes the setting; the tested skill is unchanged. |
| D        | Inverted operation | Changes the response mode, not the skill measured.  |

## 7. Answer C Concept 5

A seventh-grade science teacher ~~in a school with block scheduling~~ lectures at normal speed on photosynthesis to a class with five newcomers. ~~The class has a new set of laptops.~~ Which change best makes the lesson comprehensible to the newcomers?

**Target word:** best move for comprehensible input **Decides:** Newcomers need input made understandable, not removed.

|          |                    |                                                                      |
|----------|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Absolute language  | Content and language are learned together; delay widens gaps.        |
| B        | Dropped element    | Volume and repetition add nothing to meaning.                        |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>     | Visuals, realia, and modeling make grade-level input comprehensible. |
| D        | Inverted operation | Input far above their level is not comprehensible.                   |

## 8. Answer C Concept 6

After a three-week unit ~~taught in October~~, a teacher reports that English learners averaged 30% on the pre-assessment and 70% on the post. Non-English learners averaged 50% and 80%. ~~The principal observed one lesson.~~ Which statement is supported by the data?

**Target word:** which group gained more **Decides:** Gains: EL 40 points vs. non-EL 30 points.

|          |                   |                                                       |
|----------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| A        | Confusion set     | Confuses final level with growth.                     |
| B        | Adjacent category | Reaching a benchmark is not the same as equal growth. |
| <b>C</b> | <b>Correct</b>    | $70 - 30 = 40$ ; $80 - 50 = 30$ .                     |
| D        | Wrong stem number | Uses the post score as the gain.                      |

### 9. Answer A Concept 6 • transfer

A student scored 12 out of 20 on the pre-assessment and 18 out of 20 on the post. What is the gain in percentage points?

**Target word:** percentage-point gain **Decides:** 60% to 90%.

|   |                   |                                                            |
|---|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>    | $12/20 = 60\%$ ; $18/20 = 90\%$ ; $90 - 60 = 30$ .         |
| B | Wrong stem number | The raw-score gain, not converted to percent.              |
| C | Dropped element   | The post score alone, dropping the pre-score.              |
| D | Adjacent category | That is the relative increase ( $6 \div 12$ ), not points. |

### 10. Answer A Concept 7

A fifth grader who arrived from Brazil 14 months ago jokes easily with classmates ~~and plays on the soccer team~~, but struggles to explain answers in her social studies textbook. ~~Her older brother is in high school~~. What best explains the gap?

**Target word:** why social fluency outpaces academic work **Decides:** BICS develops before CALP.

|   |                    |                                                         |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>Correct</b>     | Her BICS is strong; CALP is still developing.           |
| B | Adjacent category  | A normal BICS–CALP gap is not evidence of a disability. |
| C | Confusion set      | Social fluency is mistaken for full proficiency.        |
| D | Inverted operation | Reverses the order: social language comes first.        |

### 11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A teacher wants an activity that builds academic language (CALP) rather than social language. Which fits best?

**Target word:** reverse: choose the CALP activity **Decides:** Academic functions in content context.

|   |                   |                                                         |
|---|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Dropped element   | Drops the content context that academic language needs. |
| B | Absolute language | Social talk does not by itself build academic language. |
| C | <b>Correct</b>    | Academic language function in a content task.           |
| D | Confusion set     | Social, conversational language.                        |

### 12. Answer B Concept 8

After a unit on fractions, 3 of 5 level-1 English learners did not meet the goal. ~~The school's science fair was held the same week~~. Which reflection is strongest for the work sample?

**Target word:** strongest reflection **Decides:** Links evidence to a teaching decision and a specific change.

|   |                   |                                                                  |
|---|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Dropped element   | Drops any change based on the evidence.                          |
| B | <b>Correct</b>    | Evidence, a named instructional cause, and a concrete next step. |
| C | Adjacent category | Blames learners instead of examining instruction.                |
| D | Absolute language | Dismisses evidence without analysis.                             |

## Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

|                       | <b>Right</b>                                          | <b>Wrong</b>                                                                          |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sure</b>           | Owned.                                                | <b>Concept inversion — top priority.</b> A wrong mental model; it survives rewording. |
| <b>Unsure / guess</b> | Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer. | Not learned yet.                                                                      |

## Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

| <b>Trap</b>        | <b>What it does</b>                                          | <b>In this drill</b> | <b>Your misses</b> |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Dropped element    | Leaves out a required term or step.                          | 6                    |                    |
| Wrong stem number  | A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.      | 3                    |                    |
| Adjacent category  | The right idea in the wrong bucket.                          | 9                    |                    |
| Inverted operation | Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower. | 3                    |                    |
| Absolute language  | Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.           | 7                    |                    |
| Confusion set      | Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.       | 7                    |                    |
| Camouflage         | Answers a stem fact that was never the question.             | 1                    |                    |

## Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

| # | Concept                                      | Rule                                                                                                                                                                | Trap                                                                                           | Tell                                                                    |
|---|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Contextual factors drive planning</b>     | Student language proficiency, background, and community context should shape goals, grouping, and scaffolds.                                                        | Treating contextual factors as a background section with no effect on the plan.                | A class profile with proficiency levels next to unrelated school facts. |
| 2 | <b>Measurable content and language goals</b> | Each goal names an observable outcome aligned to a standard, and ELL goals pair a content objective with a language objective (function plus form).                 | Writing "students will understand" or naming an activity instead of an outcome.                | Verbs like understand, learn, or complete.                              |
| 3 | <b>Pre- and post-assessment alignment</b>    | Pre- and post-assessments must measure the same goals at the same level so that a change can be read as learning.                                                   | Using a different, easier, or unrelated task for the post-assessment.                          | A post-assessment that scores something the goal never named.           |
| 4 | <b>Accommodation vs. modification</b>        | An accommodation changes how a student accesses or shows learning without changing what is measured; a modification changes the content or standard itself.         | Removing or simplifying the tested skill and calling it an accommodation.                      | "Which support keeps the test measuring the same thing?"                |
| 5 | <b>Comprehensible input</b>                  | Input slightly beyond the learner's current level, made understandable with visuals, gestures, realia, modeling, and pre-taught key vocabulary, drives acquisition. | Believing louder speech, harder texts, or waiting for fluency will help.                       | Newcomers in a content lesson delivered by lecture.                     |
| 6 | <b>Analyzing learning gains</b>              | Learning is shown by growth from pre to post (percentage-point gain) for the whole class, subgroups, and individuals, not by the post score alone.                  | Calling the group with the higher post score the group that learned more.                      | Pre and post scores for two subgroups.                                  |
| 7 | <b>BICS vs. CALP</b>                         | Conversational language (BICS) develops in about 1–3 years; academic language (CALP) takes about 5–7 years.                                                         | Assuming a student who chats fluently is fully proficient, or that a gap signals a disability. | A student fluent socially but struggling with textbooks.                |
| 8 | <b>Evidence-based reflection</b>             | Reflection links assessment evidence to specific instructional decisions and states a concrete change for next time.                                                | Blaming students or the test, or planning to repeat the same lesson unchanged.                 | "Which reflection best..." after mixed results.                         |

**Course scope (public description):** The Teacher Work Sample is a culmination of the wide variety of skills learned during your time in the Teachers College at WGU. In order to be a competent and independent classroom teacher, you will showcase a collection of your content, planning, instructional, and reflective skills in this professional assessment.